Notes From Underground References and Info

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I: Translation and Performances

- Cedar Video Transcript
- Cedar Video Guide
- Garnett Translation pdf
  - Garnett Translation txt
- Comparison Cedar Video and Garnett translation
  - in video: `simply in order to prove to themselves that men are still men and not the keys of a piano`
  - in book: `simply in order to prove to himself, as though that were so necessary, men still are men and not the keys of a pian`
- NOTES FROM THE UNDERGROUND, The Classic Story from Fyodor Dostoevsky, COMPLETE BOOK, Both Parts., Youtube audio, 4:21:21
  - reading of classic translation by Constance Garnett

    Description: *Dostoevsky's Notes from Underground isn't just a novel—it's a psychological descent into the mind of a man who both despises and craves human connection. The Underground Man, bitterly intelligent and painfully self-aware, dismantles every ideal of rational progress, exposing the contradictions of the human soul. Is he a tragic victim of modernity or just a self-absorbed misanthrope? With its raw confessions, philosophical rebellion, and chilling honesty, this book set the stage for existentialism and remains one of the most haunting character studies ever written. Step into the darkness of the underground—if you dare.*
- Pevear and Volokhonsky translation
- MacAndrew Translation
  - This Signet 1961 edition of Dostoevsky short storeis also includes:
    - Whie Nights
    - The Dream of a Ridiculout Man
    - Selections from The House of The Dead
    - An afterward giving much information about Dostoevsky and his writing.
      - Here is MacAndrew's description of Notes from Undeground:

In Notes from Underground, Dostoyevsky attacks the Crystal Palace, i.e., man-made, socialist utopia, on the grounds that man is a fickle, unreasonable animal who could never live in an edifice based on reason: man's whims and wishes are bound to clash with his enlightened self-interest. Thus, Dostoyevsky explains, man is unlike the ant which, as some might say today, is totally integrated in its group-the anthill-and feels physically, and in whatever other way an ant feels, fulfilled in acting for the general good of the anthill.

While the anthill is the ant's end in itself, to man its equivalent is only a never-attainable mirage, and the meaning of his life lies in building a road toward it. But being too lucid, the underground man knows this, and so can find no solace in road-building.

For those who pretend to reach out for the Absolute through aesthetics by claiming to "devote their lives to the good and the beautiful," he has nothing but scorn. Here, while he is at it, Dostoyevsky takes a few sideswipes at some of his contemporaries with whom he disagreed and who irritated him (the painter Gue, the critic Chemyshevsky, the writer Saltykov-Shchedrin, etc.) but these appear only as incidental allusions in double references which have an overriding general import

II: Scott writing related to *Notes from Underground*

- Week1: Notes from Undeground
  - Notes on *Notes from the Undeground* -assigned reading for Week 1.
- DMC: Notes from Underground Context
- Not the Keys of a Piano dialog, with links to clips
- Powerpoint for Week1
  - Created with three references above in mind.
  - Ends with first three cartoons in: DMC: Cartoons
- PDF version of powerpoint for Week1
  - Slide 3 and 12 of the Powerpoint are repeated first without the popup, and second with the popup.

III: External References

Links to series of lectures on the philosophy of *Notes from Underground*, by Gregory B. Sadler, "That Philosophy Guy":

These were in a footnote in Notes on *Notes from the Undeground*

- Notes From Underground | Existentialist Philosophy & Literature, YouTube 1:01:12
  - Here is a (computer generated) transcript of the above, divided into sections.
- Notes From Underground | Intellectuals Inertia and Negativity | Core Concepts, YouTube 17:26
- Notes From Underground | Pleasure, Perversity, and Suffering | Core Concepts, YouTube 16:06
- Notes From Underground | Revenge, Anger, and Justice | Core Concepts, YouTube 19:41
- Notes From Underground | Desire and Reason | Core Concepts, YouTube 17:59
- Notes From Underground | Self-Interest and the Advantageous | Core Concepts, YouTube 14:25
- Notes From Underground | The Most Advantageous Advantage | Core Concepts, YouTube 18:23
- Notes From Underground | Enlightenment, Laws of Nature, and The Will | Core Concepts, YouTube 16:14

More references

- The Death of The Rational Man: Why Dostoevsky's Underground Still Haunts Modernity?, The Third CitizenSep 13, 2025
  - PDF version

    > *Fyodor Dostoevsky's "Notes from Underground" is more than a novel; it's a chilling prophecy of modern consciousness. Plunge into the mind of the Underground Man, a figure consumed by alienation, resentment, and an irrationality that challenges everything we believe about reason and progress. This deep dive explores how Dostoevsky anticipated existentialism and why his insights into human nature, suffering, and the terrifying burden of free will are more relevant than ever for understanding ourselves and the world around us.*

- Doestoevski's Exile to Siberia, Shuman, R. Baird Published in: 2023 2 of 4Published in:2023
  - version on EBSCO site
- Notes From Underground Summaryt and Literary Devices
  - PDF version
- 20 of the best book quotes from Underground Man
- Existentialism from Dotoevsky to Sartra, by Walter Kaufman
- Super Summary Study Guides to Notes from Undeground'
- Dostoevsky's Underground Man: Prophet or 19th-Century Incel?, Jason Tebbe August 19, 2019
- Jordan Peterson's Brilliant Breakdown on DOSTOYEVSKY "Notes From Underground", YouTube, 9:04
- What Putin Gets Wrong About Tolstoy, Dostoevsky, and the Russian Soul, Nadine B Jursten, Mar 20, 2022, Updated: Apr 22, 2023.